

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 6

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

072. Chapter 6 verse 1

VERSE 6.1

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
अनाश्रितः कर्मफलं कार्यं कर्म करोति यः ।
स संन्यासी च योगी च न निरग्निर्न चाक्रियः ॥१॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
anāśritaḥ karmaphalaṁ
kāryaṁ karma karoti yaḥ |
sa sannyāsī ca yogī ca na niragnirna cākriyaḥ ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ anāśritaḥ – not depending on; karma-phalam – the fruit of action; ◆ kāryam – that which ought to be done (duty); karma – action; karoti – performs; yaḥ – who; ◆ saḥ – he; sannyāsī – a renunciant; ca – and; yogī – a Yogi; ca – and; na – not; niragnih – one without fire (rituals); na – nor; ca – and; akriyaḥ – one without action.

He who performs the prescribed duty without depending on the fruits of work is a sannyasi and a yogi, and not he who has merely ceased performing sacrifices such as Agnihotra yajna or abandoned bodily activities.

073. Chapter 6 verse 2

VERSE 6.2

यं संन्यासमिति प्राहुर्योगं तं विदधि पाण्डव ।
न ह्यसंन्यस्तसङ्कल्पो योगी भवति कश्चन ॥२॥

yam sannyāsamiti prāhur
yogaṁ taṁ viddhi pāṇḍava |
na hyasaṁnyastasaṅkalpo
yogī bhavati kaścana ||

◆ yam – which; sannyāsam – renunciation; iti – thus; prāhuḥ – they call; ◆
yogaṁ – Yoga; taṁ – that; viddhi – know; pāṇḍava – O Pandava; ◆ na – not; hi –
indeed; asaṁnyasta-saṅkalpaḥ – one who has not renounced worldly thoughts/
desires; ◆ yogī – a Yogi; bhavati – becomes; kaścana – anyone.

**O Arjuna! That which is called sannyasa, know that to be
yoga also; no one who has not given up desire can ever
become a yogi.**

074. Chapter 6 verses 3-4

VERSE 6.3

आरुरुक्षोर्मुनेर्योगं कर्म कारणमुच्यते ।
योगारूढस्य तस्यैव शमः कारणमुच्यते ॥ ३ ॥

ārurukṣormuneryogaṃ
karma kāraṇamucyate |
yogārūḍhasya tasyaiva
śamaḥ kāraṇamucyate ||

ārurukṣoḥ – for one who wishes to ascend; muneḥ – of the sage; yogam – Yoga;
karma – action; kāraṇam – the means/cause; ucyate – is said to be; yoga-
ārūḍhasya – of one who has ascended to Yoga; tasya – of him; eva – only; śamaḥ
– serenity/quiescence; kāraṇam – the means; ucyate – is said to be.

**For the sage aspiring to ascend to yoga, action is said to be
the means; and for the same sage enthroned in yoga serenity
is called the means.**

VERSE 6.4

यदा हि नेन्द्रियार्थेषु न कर्मस्वनुषज्जते ।
सर्वसङ्कल्पसंन्यासी योगारूढस्तदोच्यते ॥४॥

yadā hi nendriyārtheṣu
na karmasvanuṣajjate |
sarvasaṅkalpasannyāsī
yogārūḍhastadocyate ||

◆ yadā – when; hi – indeed; na – not; indriya-artheṣu – in the objects of the senses; ◆ na – not; karmasu – in actions; anuṣajjate – is attached; ◆ sarvasaṅkalpa-sannyāsī – the renouncer of all worldly thoughts; ◆ yoga-ārūḍhaḥ – established in Yoga; tadā – then; ucyate – is said to be.

When the sage feels no attachment for sense-objects and actions, renouncing the ego-centric will (saṃkalpa) then he is said to be enthroned in yoga.

075. Chapter 6 verses 5-6

VERSE 6.5

उद्धरेदात्मनात्मानं नात्मानमवसादयेत् ।
आत्मैव ह्यात्मनो बन्धुरात्मैव रिपुरात्मनः ॥५॥

uddharedātmanātmānam
nātmānamavasādayet |
ātmaiva hyātmano bandhur
ātmaiva ripurātmanas ||

uddharet – one should lift/elevate; ātmanā – by the self; ātmānam – the self; na – not; ātmānam – the self; avasādayet – should let sink/degrade; ātmā eva – the self alone; hi – indeed; ātmanah – of the self; bandhuh – friend; ātmā eva – the self alone; ripuh – enemy; ātmanah – of the self.

Let a man be lifted up by his own self; let him not lower himself; for he himself is his friend, and he himself is his enemy.

VERSE 6.6

बन्धुरात्मात्मनस्तस्य येनात्मैवात्मना जितः ।
अनात्मनस्तु शत्रुत्वे वर्ते तात्मैव शत्रुवत् ॥६॥

bandhurātmātmanastasya
yenātmaivātmanā jitaḥ |
anātmanastu śatrutve
vartetātmaiva śatruvat ||

◆ bandhuḥ – friend; ātmā – the self; ātmanah – of the self; tasya – of him; ◆ yena – by whom; ātmā – the self; eva – alone; ātmanā – by the self; jitaḥ – is conquered; ◆ anātmanah – for the unconquered self; tu – but; śatrutve – in the state of an enemy; ◆ varteta – would act; ātmā eva – the self alone; śatru-vat – like an enemy.

**For those who have conquered the mind, it is their friend.
For those who have failed to do so, the mind works like an
enemy.**

076. Chapter 6 verse 7

VERSE 6.7

जितात्मनः प्रशान्तस्य परमात्मा समाहितः ।
शीतोष्णसुखदुःखेषु तथा मानापमानयोः ॥ ७ ॥

jitātmanah praśāntasya
paramātmā samāhitaḥ |
śītoṣṇasukhaduḥkheṣu
tathā mānāpamānayoḥ ||

◆ jita-ātmanah – of the self-conquered; praśāntasya – of the serene; ◆ parama-
ātmā – the Supreme Self; samāhitaḥ – is steadily established; ◆ śīta-uṣṇa – in
cold and heat; sukha-duḥkheṣu – in pleasure and pain; ◆ tathā – as also; māna-
apamānayoḥ – in honor and dishonor.

**The man who has subdued the mind and is full of peace
experiences the Supreme Self under all conditions in heat
and cold, pleasure and pain, honour and dishonour. (The
mind of such a man experiences the Self under all
conditions).**

077. Chapter 6 verses 8-9

VERSE 6.8

ज्ञानविज्ञानतृप्तात्मा कूटस्थो विजितेन्द्रियः ।
युक्त इत्युच्यते योगी समलोष्टाश्मकाञ्चनः ॥ ८ ॥

jñānavijñānatṛptātmā
kūṭastho vijitendriyaḥ |
yukta ityucyate yogī
samaloṣṭāśmakāñcanaḥ ||

◆ jñāna-vijñāna-tṛpta-ātmā – whose self is satisfied with knowledge and realization; ◆ kūṭasthaḥ – unchangeable/immovable; vijita-indriyaḥ – who has subdued the senses; ◆ yuktaḥ – disciplined/harmonized; iti – thus; ucyate – is called; yogī – a Yogi; ◆ sama-loṣṭa-āśma-kāñcanaḥ – to whom a clod of earth, a stone, and gold are the same.

The yogi who is satisfied with the knowledge of the Sastras and experience of the Self, who is immovable, who has conquered the senses, who look with an equal eye on mud, stone and gold, is said to be united or harmonised in yoga.

VERSE 6.9

सुहृन्मित्रार्युदासीनमध्यस्थद्वेष्यबन्धुषु ।
साधुष्वपि च पापेषु समबुद्धिर्विशिष्यते ॥९॥

suhṛṇmitrāryudāsīna
madhyasthadveṣyabandhuṣu |
sādhuṣvapi ca pāpeṣu
samabuddhirviśiṣyate ||

◆ suhṛt – well-wisher; mitra – friend; ari – enemy; udāsīna – the indifferent; ◆
madhyastha – the neutral; dveṣya – the hateful; bandhuṣu – and relatives; ◆
sādhuṣu – in the righteous; api – also; ca – and; pāpeṣu – in the sinful; ◆ sama-
buddhiḥ – equal-minded; viśiṣyate – is pre-eminent/excels.

He who is equal-minded towards the good-hearted, friends, enemies, the indifferent, neutrals, haters, relations, towards the righteous and also the wicked, excels.

078. Chapter 6 verses 10-14

VERSE 6.10

योगी युञ्जीत सततमात्मानं रहसि स्थितः ।
एकाकी यतचित्तात्मा निराशीरपरिग्रहः ॥ 10 ॥

yogī yuñjīta satatam
ātmānam rahasi sthitaḥ |
ekākī yatacittātmā
nirāśīraparigrahaḥ ||

yogī – the Yogi; yuñjīta – should engage/practice; satatam – constantly;
ātmānam – the self; rahasi – in secret/solitude; sthitaḥ – remaining; ekākī –
alone; yata-citta-ātmā – with mind and self controlled; nirāśīḥ – free from hope;
aparigrahaḥ – free from possessions.

Alone, stationed in a solitary place, self-controlled, free from desire, and not receiving anything from others, the yogi (Practising Dhyanayoga) should unite the mind with Atma.

शुचौ देशे प्रतिष्ठाप्य स्थिरमासनमात्मनः ।
नात्युच्छ्रितं नातिनीचं चैलाजिनकुशोत्तरम् ॥ 11 ॥
तत्रैकाग्रं मनः कृत्वा यतचित्तेन्द्रियक्रियः ।
उपविश्यासने युञ्ज्याद्योगमात्मविशुद्धये ॥ 12 ॥

śucau deśe pratiṣṭhāpya
sthiramāsanamātmanah |
nātyucchritaṃ nātinīcaṃ
cailājinaakuśottaram || 11 ||

tatraikāgraṃ manaḥ kṛtvā yatacittendriyakriyaḥ | upaviśyāsane yuñjyād
yogāmātmaviśuddhaye || 12 ||

In a clean spot, a firm seat should be made, neither too high nor too low, and it should be covered by cloth, skin, and holy grass one over the other. There, being seated, having made the mind one-pointed, controlling the actions of the mind and the senses, let him practice Dhyana Yoga for self-purification.

VERSE 6.13-14

समं कायशिरोग्रीवं धारयन्नचलं स्थिरः ।
सम्प्रेक्ष्य नासिकाग्रं स्वं दिशश्चानवलोकयन् ॥ 13 ॥
प्रशान्तात्मा विगतभीर्ब्रह्मचारिव्रते स्थितः ।
मनः संयम्य मच्चित्तो युक्त आसीत् मत्परः ॥ 14 ॥

samaṁ kāyaśirogrīvaṁ
dhārayannacalaṁ sthiraḥ |
sampirekṣya nāsikāgraṁ svaṁ
diśaścānavalokayan || 13 ||

praśāntātmā vigatabhīr brahmacārivrate sthitaḥ | manaḥ saṁyamyā maccitto
yukta āsīta matparaḥ || 14 ||

**Let him firmly hold the body, head and neck erect, and
gazing on the tip of his nose, without looking around, let him
sit, serene and fearless, established in the vow of celibacy,
self-controlled and balanced, thinking of Me as the Supreme
goal.**

079. Chapter 6 verse 15

VERSE 6.15

युञ्जन्नेवं सदात्मानं योगी नियतमानसः ।
शान्तिं निर्वाणपरमां मत्संस्थामधिगच्छति ॥ 15 ॥

yuñjannevaṃ sadātmānaṃ
yogī niyatamānasaḥ |
śāntiṃ nirvāṇaparamāṃ
matsaṃsthāmadhigacchati ||

◆ yuñjan – practicing; evaṃ – thus; sadā – constantly; ātmānaṃ – the self; ◆
yogī – the Yogi; niyata-mānasaḥ – with controlled mind; ◆ śāntim – peace;
nirvāṇa-paramāṃ – that culminates in Nirvana (liberation); ◆ mat-saṃsthām –
which abides in Me; adhigacchati – attains.

**Thus the self-controlled Yogi holding the mind in meditation
on the Self, attains peace abiding in me which culminates in
the highest bliss of liberation.**

080. Chapter 6 verses 16-19

VERSE 6.16

नात्यश्नतस्तु योगो ऽस्ति न चैकान्तमनश्नतः ।
न चाति स्वप्नशीलस्य जाग्रतो नैव चार्जुन ॥ 16 ॥

nātyaśnatastu yogo'sti
na caikāntamanaśnataḥ |
na cāti svapnaśīlasya
jāgrato naiva cārjuna ||

na – not; ati aśnataḥ – for him who eats too much; tu – but; yogaḥ – Yoga; asti – is; na – not; ca – and; ekāntam – at all; anaśnataḥ – for him who does not eat; na – not; ca – and; ati – too much; svapna-śīlasya – for him who is addicted to sleep; jāgrataḥ – who is awake; na eva – nor indeed; ca – and; arjuna – O Arjuna.

O Arjuna! Verily, yoga is not for one who eats too much or who does not eat at all, nor for him who sleeps too much or who does not sleep at all.

VERSE 6.17

युक्ताहारविहारस्य युक्तचेष्टस्य कर्मसु ।
युक्तस्वप्नावबोधस्य योगो भवति दुःखहा ॥ 17 ॥

yuktāhāravihārasya
yuktaceṣṭasya karmasu |
yuktasvapnāvobodhasya
yogo bhavati duḥkhahā ||

yukta-āhāra-vihārasya – of him who is moderate in eating and recreation;
yukta-ceṣṭasya – who is moderate in exertion; karmasu – in actions; yukta-
svapna-avobodhasya – who is moderate in sleep and wakefulness; yogaḥ – Yoga;
bhavati – becomes; duḥkha-hā – the destroyer of sorrow.

For him who is moderate in food and recreation, moderate in exertion in all actions, moderate in sleep and wakefulness, yoga destroys all pain and suffering (caused by birth and death).

VERSE 6.18

यदा विनियतं चित्तमात्मन्येवावतिष्ठते ।
निःस्पृहः सर्वकामेभ्यो युक्त इत्युच्यते तदा ॥ 18 ॥

yadā viniyatam cittam
ātmanyevāvatiṣṭhate |
niḥspṛhaḥ sarvakāmebhyo
yukta ityucyate tadā ||

yadā – when; viniyatam – perfectly controlled; cittam – mind; ātmani – in the Self; eva – only; avatiṣṭhate – rests; niḥspṛhaḥ – free from longing; sarvakāmebhyah – for all desires; yuktaḥ – disciplined; iti – thus; ucyate – is called; tadā – then.

When the perfectly controlled mind rests in the Self free from longing for all enjoyments, then one is said to have attained yoga.

VERSE 6.19

यथा दीपो निवातस्थो नेङ्गते सोपमा स्मृता ।
योगिनो यतचित्तस्य युञ्जतो योगमात्मनः ॥ 19 ॥

yathā dīpo nivāstho
neṅgate sopamā smṛtā |
yogino yatacittasya
yuñjato yogamātmanah ||

◆ yathā – as; dīpah – a lamp; nivāsthaḥ – placed in a windless spot; ◆ na
iṅgate – does not flicker; sā – that; upamā – simile; smṛtā – is thought (of); ◆
yoginah – of the Yogi; yata-cittasya – of the controlled mind; ◆ yuñjataḥ –
practicing; yogam – Yoga; ātmanah – of the self.

**Just as a lamp in a windless place does not flicker, so the
disciplined mind of a yogi remains steady in meditation on
the Supreme.**

081. Chapter 6 verses 20-21

VERSE 6.20-21

यत्परोपरमते चित्तं निरुद्धं योगसेवया ।
यत्र चैवात्मनात्मानं पश्यन्नात्मनि तुष्यति ॥२०॥

yatroparamate cittam
niruddham yogasevayā |
yatra caivātmanātmānam
paśyannātmani tuṣyati ||

◆ yatra – where; uparamate – becomes quiet/quiescent; cittam – mind; ◆
niruddham – restrained; yoga-sevayā – by the practice of Yoga; ◆ yatra – where;
ca eva – and also; ātmanā – by the self (purified mind); ātmānam – the Self; ◆
paśyan – beholding; ātmani – in the Self; tuṣyati – is satisfied.

When the mind (citta), restrained by the practice of yoga (yoga), comes to rest, and when, seeing the self (ātman) by means of the self (ātman), one finds satisfaction in the self (ātman). When one experiences that ultimate happiness which is comprehensible by the intellect (buddhi) and transcends the senses, being established in that truth (tattva), one does not deviate from it.

082. Chapter 6 verses 22-23

VERSE 6.22-23

यं लब्ध्वा चापरं लाभं मन्यते नाधिकं ततः ।
यस्मिन्स्थितो न दुःखेन गुरुणापि विचाल्यते ॥ 22 ॥

yam labdhvā cāparam lābham
manyate nādhikam tataḥ |
yasminsthito na duḥkhena
guruṇāpi vicālyate || 22 ||

yam – which; labdhvā – having obtained; ca – and; aparam – other; lābham – gain; manyate – considers; na adhikam – not greater; tataḥ – than that; yasmin – in which; sthito – established; na – not; duḥkhena – by sorrow; guruṇā api – even by heavy/great; vicālyate – is moved;

Having attained that (state of yoga), one does not consider any other gain to be greater than it. Being established in that (state), one is not disturbed even by the greatest sorrow.

083. Chapter 6 verses 24-25

VERSE 6.24-25

सङ्कल्पप्रभवान्कामास्त्यक्त्वा सर्वानशेषतः ।
मनसैवेन्द्रियग्रामं विनियम्य समन्ततः ॥ 24 ॥

saṅkalpaprabhavāṅkāmaṃs
tyaktvā sarvānaśeṣataḥ |
manasaivendriyagrāmaṃ
viniyamya samantataḥ ||

◆ saṅkalpa-prabhavān – born of imagination/willful thought; kāmaṃ – desires;
◆ tyaktvā – having abandoned; sarvān – all; aśeṣataḥ – completely; ◆ manasā –
by the mind; eva – alone; indriya-grāmaṃ – the whole group of senses; ◆
viniyamya – restraining; samantataḥ – from all sides.

**Abandoning completely all desires born of 'Sankalpa'
(thought/imagination), and restraining the whole group of
senses from all sides by the mind alone,**

084. Chapter 6 verses 26-27

VERSE 6.26

यतो यतो निश्चरति मनश्चञ्चलमस्थिरम् ।
ततस्ततो नियम्यैतदात्मन्येव वशं नयेत् ॥ 26 ॥

yato yato niścarati
manaścañcalamasthiram |
tatastato niyamyaitad
ātmanyeva vaśam nayet ||

◆ yataḥ yataḥ – from whatever cause; niścarati – wanders; ◆ manaḥ – the mind;
cañcalam – restless; asthiram – unsteady; ◆ tataḥ tataḥ – from that; niyamyā –
restraining; etat – this; ◆ ātmani – in the Self; eva – alone; vaśam – control;
nayet – let him bring.

**Whenever and wherever the restless and unsteady mind
wanders, one should bring it back and continually focus it on
God.**

VERSE 6.27

प्रशान्तमनसं ह्येनं योगिनं सुखमुत्तमम् ।
उपैति शान्तरजसं ब्रह्मभूतमकल्मषम् ॥ 27 ॥

praśāntamanasaṃ hyenaṃ
yoginaṃ sukhamuttamam |
upaiti śāntarajasam
brahmabhūtamakalmaṣam ||

◆ praśānta-manasam – whose mind is perfectly serene; hi – indeed; enam – this;
◆ yoginam – Yogi; sukham – happiness; uttamam – supreme; ◆ upaiti – comes
to; śānta-rajasaṃ – whose passion (Rajas) is quieted; ◆ brahma-bhūtam – who
has become Brahman; akalmaṣam – freed from sin.

**Supreme Bliss comes to the yogi whose mind is completely
tranquil and whose passions are quieted, who is free from
stain and who has become one with Brahman.**

085. Chapter 6 verses 28-29

VERSE 6.28

युञ्जन्नेवं सदात्मानं योगी विगतकल्मषः ।
सुखेन ब्रह्मसंस्पर्शमत्यन्तं सुखमश्नुते ॥ 28 ॥

yuñjannevaṃ sadātmānaṃ
yogī vigatakalmaṣaḥ |
sukhena brahmasaṃsparśam
atyantaṃ sukhamaśnute ||

◆ yuñjan – practicing; evaṃ – thus; sadā – constantly; ātmānam – the self; ◆
yogī – the Yogi; vigata-kalmaṣaḥ – freed from sin; ◆ sukhena – easily; brahma-
saṃsparśam – contact with Brahman; ◆ atyantam – infinite; sukham – bliss;
aśnute – enjoys.

**Thus the yogi free from evil, practising yoga (union with
Atma) always, attains easily the highest bliss resulting from
contact with Brahman.**

VERSE 6.29

सर्वभूतस्थमात्मानं सर्वभूतानि चात्मनि ।
ईक्षते योगयुक्तात्मा सर्वत्र समदर्शनः ॥ 29 ॥

sarvabhūtasthamātmānam
sarvabhūtāni cātmani |
īkṣate yogayuktātmā
sarvatra samadarśanaḥ ||

◆ sarva-bhūta-stham – abiding in all beings; ātmānam – the Self; ◆ sarva-bhūtāni – all beings; ca – and; ātmani – in the Self; ◆ īkṣate – sees; yoga-yukta-ātmā – one whose self is united through Yoga; ◆ sarvatra – everywhere; samadarśanaḥ – seeing with an equal eye.

The sage harmonised in yoga sees the Self in all beings, and all beings in the Self; he sees the same everywhere.

086. Chapter 6 verses 30-32

VERSE 6.30

यो मां पश्यति सर्वत्र सर्वं च मयि पश्यति ।
तस्याहं न प्रणश्यामि स च मे न प्रणश्यति ॥ 30 ॥

yo mām paśyati sarvatra
sarvaṃ ca mayi paśyati |
tasyāhaṃ na praṇaśyāmi
sa ca me na praṇaśyati ||

◆ yaḥ – who; mām – Me; paśyati – sees; sarvatra – everywhere; ◆ sarvaṃ – everything; ca – and; mayi – in Me; paśyati – sees; ◆ tasya – for him; aham – I; na praṇaśyāmi – am not lost; ◆ saḥ – he; ca – and; me – to Me; na praṇaśyati – is not lost.

**He who sees Me in all beings and all beings in me never
becomes lost to me, nor do I become lost to him.**

VERSE 6.31

सर्वभूतस्थितं यो मां भजत्येकत्वमास्थितः ।
सर्वथा वर्तमानोऽपि स योगी मयि वर्तते ॥ ३१ ॥

sarvabhūtasthitam yo mām
bhajatyekatvamāsthitaḥ |
sarvathā vartamāno'pi
sa yogī mayi vartate ||

◆ sarva-bhūta-sthitam – dwelling in all beings; yaḥ – who; mām – Me; ◆ bhajati – worships; ekatvam – unity; āsthitaḥ – established in; ◆ sarvathā – in every way; vartamānaḥ – acting/living; api – even; ◆ saḥ – that; yogī – Yogi; mayi – in Me; vartate – abides.

The Yogi who worships Me abiding in all beings and who is established in unity abides in me in whatever manner he is acting.

VERSE 6.32

आत्मौपम्येन सर्वत्र समं पश्यति योऽर्जुन ।
सुखं वा यदि वा दुःखं स योगी परमो मतः ॥ 32 ॥

ātmaupamyena sarvatra
samam paśyati yo'rjuna |
sukham vā yadi vā duḥkham
sa yogī paramo mataḥ ||

ātma-aupamyena – by comparison with oneself; sarvatra – everywhere; samam – equally; paśyati – sees; yaḥ – who; arjuna – O Arjuna; sukham – pleasure; vā – or; yadi – if; vā – or; duḥkham – pain; saḥ – he; yogī – Yogi; paramaḥ – supreme; mataḥ – is considered.

He who judges pleasure or pain everywhere, by the same standard as he applies to himself, that yogi is thought to be the highest.

087. Chapter 6 verses 33-35

VERSE 6.33

अर्जुन उवाच ।

योऽयं योगस्त्वया प्रोक्तः साम्येन मधुसूदन ।

एतस्याहं न पश्यामि चञ्चलत्वात्स्थितिं स्थिराम् ॥ 33 ॥

arjuna uvāca |

yo'yam yogastvayā proktaḥ

sāmyena madhusūdana |

etasyāhaṁ na paśyāmi

cañcalatvātsthitim sthirām

◆ arjunaḥ uvāca – Arjuna said; ◆ yaḥ ayam – this; yogaḥ – Yoga; tvayā – by You; proktaḥ – taught; ◆ sāmyena – as equality/equanimity; madhusūdana – O Madhusudana; ◆ etasya – of this; aham – I; na paśyāmi – do not see; ◆ cañcalatvāt – because of restlessness; sthitim – foundation/steady state; sthirām – lasting;

Arjuna said: The system of Yoga that you have described and attainable by equality of mind, O Madhusudana, appears impractical and unattainable to me, due to the restless mind.

VERSE 6.34

चञ्चलं हि मनः कृष्ण प्रमाथि बलवद्दृढम् ।
तस्याहं निग्रहं मन्ये वायोरिव सुदुष्करम् ॥ 34 ॥

cañcalam hi manaḥ kṛṣṇa
pramāthi balavaddṛḍham |
tasyāham nigrahaṁ manye
vāyoriva suduṣkaram ||

◆ cañcalam – restless; hi – indeed; manaḥ – the mind; kṛṣṇa – O Krishna; ◆
pramāthi – turbulent; balavat – strong; dṛḍham – stubborn; ◆ tasya – of it; aham
– I; nigraham – control; manye – think; ◆ vāyoḥ iva – like the wind; su-
duṣkaram – very difficult.

The mind is very restless, turbulent, strong, and obstinate, O Krishna. It appears to me that it is more difficult to control than the wind.

VERSE 6.35

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
असंशयं महाबाहो मनो दुर्निग्रहं चलम् ।
अभ्यासेन तु कौन्तेय वैराग्येण च गृह्यते ॥ 35 ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
asaṁśayaṁ mahābāho
mano durnigrahaṁ calam |
abhyāsenā tu kaunteya
vairāgyeṇa ca gr̥hyate ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ asaṁśayaṁ – without doubt; mahābāho – O mighty-armed; ◆ manaḥ – the mind; durnigrahaṁ – difficult to curb; calam – restless; ◆ abhyāsenā – by practice; tu – but; kaunteya – O son of Kunti; ◆ vairāgyeṇa – by dispassion/detachment; ca – and; gr̥hyate – is restrained;

The Lord said: Doubtless, O mighty Arjuna, the mind is restless and hard to control; but by practice and by detachment, O son of Kunti, it can be restrained.

088. Chapter 6 verses 36-42

VERSE 6.36

असंयतात्मना योगो दुष्प्राप इति मे मतिः ।
वश्यात्मना तु यतता शक्योऽवाप्तुमुपायतः ॥ 36 ॥

asaṃyatātmanā yogo
duṣprāpa iti me matiḥ |
vaśyātmanā tu yatatā
śakyo'vāptumupāyataḥ ||

◆ asaṃyata-ātmanā – by one of uncontrolled self; yogaḥ – Yoga; ◆ duṣprāpaḥ – hard to attain; iti – thus; me matiḥ – my opinion; ◆ vaśya-ātmanā – by the self-controlled; tu – but; yatatā – by the striving; ◆ śakyaḥ – possible; avāptum – to attain; upāyataḥ – through (proper) means.

Yoga is hard to attain by a man who cannot control his mind, but it can be attained by him who has controlled his mind and who strives earnestly by proper means. This is My opinion.

VERSE 6.37

अर्जुन उवाच ।

अयतिः श्रद्धयोपेतो योगाच्चलितमानसः ।

अप्राप्य योगसंसिद्धिं कां गतिं कृष्ण गच्छति ॥ 37 ॥

arjuna uvāca |

ayatiḥ śraddhayopeto

yogāccalitamānasaḥ |

aprāpya yogasaṁsiddhiṁ

kām gatiṁ kṛṣṇa gacchati ||

◆ arjunaḥ uvāca – Arjuna said; ◆ ayatiḥ – the unsuccessful; śraddhayā-upetaḥ – endowed with faith; ◆ yogāt – from Yoga; calita-mānasaḥ – whose mind has wandered; ◆ aprāpya – not having reached; yoga-saṁsiddhim – perfection in Yoga; ◆ kām gatiṁ – what end; kṛṣṇa – O Krishna; gacchati – goes to;

Arjuna said: What is the fate of the unsuccessful yogi who begins the path with faith, but who does not endeavor sufficiently due to an unsteady mind and is unable to reach the goal of Yoga in this life?

VERSE 6.38

कच्चिन्नोभयविभ्रष्टश्छिन्नाभ्रमिव नश्यति ।
अप्रतिष्ठो महाबाहो विमूढो ब्रह्मणः पथि ॥ ३८ ॥

kaccinnobhayavibhraṣṭac
chinnābhramiva naśyati |
apraṭiṣṭho mahābāho
vimūḍho brahmaṇaḥ pathi ||

◆ kaccit na – does he not; ubhaya-vibhraṣṭaḥ – fallen from both; ◆ chinna-abhram iva – like a rent cloud; naśyati – perish; ◆ apratiṣṭhaḥ – supportless; mahābāho – O mighty-armed; ◆ vimūḍhaḥ – deluded; brahmaṇaḥ pathi – on the path of Brahman;

Does not such a person who deviates from Yog get deprived of both material and spiritual success, O mighty-armed Krishna, and perish like a broken cloud with no position in either sphere?

VERSE 6.39

एतन्मे संशयं कृष्ण छेत्तुमर्हस्यशेषतः ।
त्वदन्यः संशयस्यास्य छेत्ता न ह्युपपद्यते ॥ 39 ॥

etanme saṁśayaṁ kṛṣṇa
chettumarhasyaśeṣataḥ |
tvadanyaḥ saṁśayasyāśya
chettā na hyupapadyate ||

◆ etat – this; me – my; saṁśayaṁ – doubt; kṛṣṇa – O Krishna; ◆ chettum arhasi – You should remove; aśeṣataḥ – completely; ◆ tvad-anyaḥ – other than You; ◆ chettā – remover; na hi – not indeed; upapadyate – can be found.

**You should completely dispel, O Krishna, this doubt of mine;
for no one but You can destroy such a doubt.**

VERSE 6.40

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

पार्थ नैवेह नामुत्र विनाशस्तस्य विद्यते ।

न हि कल्याणकृत्कश्चिद्दुर्गतिं तात गच्छति ॥ 40 ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |

pārtha naiveha nāmutra

vināśastasya vidyate |

na hi kalyāṇakṛtkaścid

durgatiṃ tāta gacchati ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ pārtha – O Partha; na eva iha – neither here; na amutra – nor hereafter; ◆ vināśaḥ – destruction; tasya – for him; vidyate – is; ◆ na hi – not indeed; kalyāṇa-kṛt – one who does good; kaścit – any; ◆ durgatiṃ – an evil end; tāta – O dear one; gacchati – goes to.

**The Lord said: O Pārtha, there is no destruction for him
either in this world or the next: no evil, My son, befalls a
man who does good.**

VERSE 6.41

प्राप्य पुण्यकृतां लोकानुषित्वा शाश्वतीः समाः ।
शुचीनां श्रीमतां गेहे योगभ्रष्टोऽभिजायते ॥ 41 ॥

prāpya puṇyakṛtān lokān
uṣitvā śāśvatīḥ samāḥ |
śucīnām śrīmatām gehe
yoga-bhraṣṭaḥ abhijāyate ||

◆ **prāpya**—attain; **puṇya-kṛtām**—of the virtuous; **lokān**—abodes; ◆ **uṣitvā**—after dwelling; **śhāśvatīḥ**—many; **samāḥ**—ages; ◆ **śucīnām**—of the pious; **śrī-matām**—of the prosperous; **gehe**—in the house; ◆ **yoga-bhraṣṭaḥ**—the unsuccessful yogis; **abhijāyate**—take birth;

The man who has fallen away from yoga goes to the worlds of the righteous. Having lived there for unnumbered years, he is reborn in the home of the pure and the prosperous.

VERSE 6.42

अथवा योगिनामेव कुले भवति धीमताम् ।
एतद्धि दुर्लभतरं लोके जन्म यदीदृशम् ॥ 42 ॥

atha vā yoginām eva
kule bhavati dhīmatām |
etad dhi durlabhataram
loke janma yad īdṛśham ||

◆ **atha vā**—else; **yoginām**—of those endowed with divine wisdom; **eva**—certainly; ◆ **kule**—in the family; **bhavati**—take birth; **dhī-matām**—of the wise; ◆ **etad**—this; **hi**—certainly; **durlabha-taram**—very rare; ◆ **loke**—in this world; **janma**—birth; **yad**—which; **īdṛśham**—like this

Or he is born into a family of yogis rich in wisdom. Verily,
such a birth is hard to gain in this world.

089. Chapter 6 verses 43-47

VERSE 6.43

तत्र तं बुद्धिसंयोगं लभते पौर्वदेहिकम् ।
यतते च ततो भूयः संसिद्धौ कुरुनन्दन ॥ 43 ॥

tatra taṁ buddhi-sanyogaṁ
labhate paurva-dehikam |
yatate ca tato bhūyaḥ
sansiddhau kuru-nandana ||

◆ **tatra**—there; **taṁ**—that; **buddhi-sanyogaṁ**—reawaken their wisdom; ◆
labhate—obtains; **paurva-dehikam**—from the previous lives; ◆ **yatate**—strives;
ca—and; **tataḥ**—thereafter; **bhūyaḥ**—again; ◆ **sansiddhau**—for perfection;
kuru-nandana—Arjun, descendant of the Kurus

There he comes in touch with the knowledge acquired in his former body, O son of the Kurus, and strives still further for perfection.

VERSE 6.44

पूर्वाभ्यासेन तेनैव हिरयते ह्यवशोऽपि सः ।
जिज्ञासुरपि योगस्य शब्दब्रह्मातिवर्तते ॥ 44 ॥

pūrvābhyāsenā tenaiva
hriyate hyavaśho 'pi saḥ |
jijñāsuraḥ api yogasya
śhabda-brahmātivartate ||

◆ **pūrvā**—past; **abhyāsenā**—discipline; **tena**—by that; **eva**—certainly; ◆ **hriyate**—is attracted; **hi**—surely; **avaśhaḥ**—helplessly; **api**—although; **saḥ**—that person; ◆ **jijñāsuraḥ**—inquisitive; **api**—even; **yogasya**—about yog; ◆ **śhabda-brahma**—fruitive portion of the Vedas; **ativartate**—transcends

Indeed, they feel drawn toward God, even against their will, on the strength of their past discipline. Such seekers naturally rise above the ritualistic principles of the scriptures.

VERSE 6.45

प्रयत्नाद्यतमानस्तु योगी संशुद्धकिल्बिषः ।
अनेकजन्मसंसिद्धस्ततो याति परां गतिम् ॥ 45 ॥

prayatnād yatamānas tu
yogī sanśhuddha-kilbiṣhaḥ |
aneka-janma-sansiddhas
tato yāti parām gatim ||

◆ **prayatnāt**—with great effort; **yatamānaḥ**—endeavoring; **tu**—and; ◆ **yogī**—a yogi; **sanśhuddha**—purified; **kilbiṣhaḥ**—from material desires; ◆ **aneka**—after many, many; **janma**—births; **sansiddhaḥ**—attain perfection; ◆ **tataḥ**—then; **yāti**—attains; **parām**—the highest; **gatim**—path

Practising assiduously, the yogi having acquired perfection through many births attains the supreme state (Moksha) purified of all sins.

VERSE 6.46

तपस्विभ्योऽधिकोयोगी
ज्ञानिभ्योऽपिमतोऽधिकः।
कर्मिभ्यश्चाधिकोयोगी
तस्माद्योगीभवार्जुन ॥ 46 ॥

tapasvibhyo'dhiko yogī
jñānibhyo'pi mato'dhikaḥ |
karmibhyoścādhiko yogī
tasmādyogī bhavārjuna ||

◆ tapasvibhyaḥ – than the ascetics; adhikaḥ – superior; yogī – the Yogi; ◆
jñānibhyaḥ – than the scholars; api – even; mataḥ – is considered; adhikaḥ –
superior; ◆ karmibhyaḥ – than the ritualists; ca – and; yogī – the Yogi; ◆ tasmāt
– therefore; yogī bhava – become a Yogi; arjuna – O Arjuna;

**O Arjuna! The yogi is thought to be greater than the ascetic,
greater than the learned, and greater than the man of
action; therefore be a yogi.**

VERSE 6.47

योगिनामपि सर्वेषां मद्गतेनान्तरात्मना ।
श्रद्धावान्भजते यो मां स मे युक्ततमो मतः ॥ 47 ॥

yogināmapī sarveṣāṃ
madgatenāntarātmanā |
śraddhāvānbhajate yo mām
sa me yuktatamo mataḥ ||

◆ tapasvibhyaḥ – than the ascetics; adhikaḥ – superior; yogī – the Yogi; ◆
jñānibhyaḥ – than the scholars; api – even; mataḥ – is considered; adhikaḥ –
superior; ◆ karmibhyaḥ – than the ritualists; ca – and; yogī – the Yogi; ◆ tasmāt
– therefore; yogī bhava – become a Yogi; arjuna – O Arjuna;

**Even among yogis, he who worships Me with mind fixed in
Me, full of faith, is deemed by me to be the most devout.**